

Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: October 11, 2026	**Entry:** #1
Description	There were two phases of the incident In the first phase the organization detected the incident and contacted other organizations for technical help. In the second phase, the organization took steps to contain the incident. The company shut down their computer systems, but needed the help of other organizations to eradicate the threat.
Tool(s) used	None
The 5 W's	• **Who** An organized group of unethical hackers • **What** A ransomware security incident • **When** Tuesday 9:00 am • **Where** At a health care company • **Why** The hackers were able to access a company's systems through a phishing attack. Once they had access, they launched ransomware onto the companies systems which encrypted critical files. They demanded a large sum of money for the decryption key through the ransomware.
Additional notes	How could the health care company prevent this type of attack from

	happening again? Should the company pay the ransom to stop the attack and obtain the decryption key.

Date: October 11, 2026	**Entry:** #2
Description	Analysis of a packet capture file
Tool(s) used	Wireshark was used to analyze the packet capture file.
The 5 W's	• **Who** N/A • **What** N/A • **When** N/A • **Where** N/A • **Why** N/A
Additional notes	Wireshark seems to be a powerful tool for analysis on packet capture files.

Date: October 11, 2026	**Entry:** #3
Description	Capture of a packet

Tool(s) used	Tcpdump was used to analyze network traffic.
The 5 W's	• **Who** N/A • **What** N/A • **When** N/A • **Where** N/A • **Why** N/A
Additional notes	Tcpdump is a powerful command line tool for analyzing network traffic

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Date: October 11, 2026	**Entry:** **#4**
Description	Investigate a suspicious file hash
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal was used to analyze URLs for malicious content.
The 5 W's	• **Who** Unknown malicious hacker • **What** An email was sent with a malicious file • **When** An employee's computer at a financial services company • **Where** At 1:20 pm the organization's intrusion detection system detected the file • **Why** An employee downloaded a malicious file linked in an email attachment
Additional notes	How can this incident be prevented in the future?